

HTC ChaCha launched in India for Rs 15,990

HTC Corporation has teamed up with Tata DoCoMo to launch the HTC ChaCha smartphone in India. This Android-powered device features a dedicated Facebook button that allows you to share just about anything, with a single touch. The one-touch access to the Facebook service has been integrated throughout the HTC Sense experience.

The feature-packed smartphone combines a 6.6-cm (2.6-inch) touch screen with a full QWERTY keypad. It comes equipped with a 5-megapixel colour camera with auto focus and an LED flash. It also features a VGA front-facing camera.

Under the terms of the package offered, Tata DoCoMo 3G prepaid customers can avail 3 GB of free data, an offer valid for a period of 90 days, whereas 1GB of free data is offered free each month to postpaid customers across all 3G circles—for a period of 90 days. All 3G customers will also get 3 hours of free Mobile TV that includes data access charges—valid for 90 days.

While Tata DoCoMo 2G prepaid customers can avail 3GB of free data and 300 minutes of Tata-to-Tata local calls (valid for a period of 90 days), postpaid customers across all 2G circles get 1GB of free data and 100 minutes of talk time for Tata-to-Tata calls each month, for three months.

The new HTC ChaCha is priced at Rs 15,990 in India.



ASUS Transformer: A tablet cum notebook

ASUS Technology has rolled out the ASUS EEE Pad Transformer TF101 tablet in India, which runs the latest Android Honeycomb operating system from Google and uses a dual-core Tegra 2 processor. The new offering, weighing 680 grams and sporting a thickness of 13 mm, distinguishes itself from the sea of tablets with an optional accessory that transforms it into a notebook.

The optional docking station transforms it into a full-fledged notebook PC, replete with a QWERTY keyboard. The dock includes its own battery that the company claims boosts the standby time from 6 hours to 16 hours. This is in addition to a multi-touch touchpad, two USB ports, a 3.5 mm audio jack, and a built-in SD card reader—all included in the optional attachment. Moreover, the last three features are present on the tablet too.

The tablet comes preloaded with Polaris Office 3.0, a professional mobile office solution that helps users edit various types of office documents, and a year's worth of ASUS WebStorage for your distributed computing needs. The company has priced the tablet at an MRP of Rs 32,999.



LG Optimus Black arrives in India

LG has announced the launch of LG Optimus Black in India.

The device is available at a price of Rs 19,990.

Weighing just 109 grams, this is one of the lightest high-end Android smartphones. The entire body of the Optimus Black is made up of plastic, thus considerably cutting down on the weight of the device.

There is also a 5 MP camera capable of recording 720p HD video at 30fps, and a 2 MP front facing camera for video calls. Powered by a 1 GHz TI OMAP processor, the handset has a 10.2 cm NOVA display, 512 MB of RAM, 2 GB of internal storage, and Android 2.2 Froyo with LG Optimus UI 2.0 and Gesture UI 2.0.



Samung launches Galaxy Tab 10.1 in Korea

Samsung Electronics has come out with a thinner and lighter version of its Galaxy tablet to lure consumers away from Apple's iPad in its lucrative home market. Powered by Android's Honeycomb 3.1, the new Galaxy Tab 10.1 is an upgraded version of the 17.8-cm (7-inch) Tab introduced in October. It features a 1280 x 800 capacitive touchscreen, a dual-core NVIDIA Tegra 2 1 GHz chip, 1 GB of RAM, Wi-Fi and Bluetooth, with front and rear cameras.

The company claims it is the world's thinnest tablet, measuring 8.6 mm and its price will start at \$634 in South Korea. "It is very thin... and weighs just as much as a cup of takeout coffee," the company said in a statement.

